

Purple Line Light Rail Transit System Environmental Impact Statement

Background

Maryland communities in the Washington, D.C., metropolitan area benefit from robust north-south transportation access provided by regional roadways and the Metrorail/Metrobus transit system. However, east to west mobility is lacking; the existing highway network has limited capacity and existing transit service is inefficient.

To address this need, the Maryland Transit Administration (MTA) proposed the development of a new, light rail transit system known as the Purple Line. The Purple Line runs along a 16-mile corridor, extending from Bethesda in Montgomery County to New Carrollton in Prince George's County. The Purple Line will provide direct connections to the Metrorail Red, Green, and Orange transit lines and was designed to improve transit-travel times and support community revitalization and transit-oriented development.

Scope

Gannett Fleming, as part of a joint venture, is performing as the General Engineering Consultant, providing engineering and environmental services for final planning and design for the Purple Line system.

In development of the Final Environmental Impact Statement (EIS), our firm provided the overall environmental management of the National Environmental Policy Act (NEPA) process. NEPA compliance included the interdisciplinary analyses of significant project concerns, including economic impacts; noise impacts; visual effects; and effects on neighborhoods.

Accomplishments

Our firm's FEIS documentation impressed MTA and the Federal Transit Administration (FTA). FTA's review committee noted that the documentation exemplified best practices for a well-managed environmental documentation process. The FTA's review committee was especially impressed with

FINAL ENVIRONMENTAL IMPACT STATEMENT & DRAFT SECTION 4(F) EVALUATION

VOLUME I



The FEIS documentation for the Purple Line won an Outstanding Achievement Award of Excellence in Environmental Document Preparation from the FTA.

Client

Maryland Transit Administration

Location

Montgomery and Prince George's Counties,
Maryland

the presentation of the information—the use of reader-friendly language, graphics, and tables. We successfully resolved the complicated environmental issues to FTA's satisfaction.

Awards

- Outstanding Achievement Award of Excellence in Environmental Document Preparation for the Purple Line's FEIS, 2015, Federal Transit Administration